

DEMOCRACY MATTERS \* DAY8

# Democracy Matters

Today's Special Topic: **Bypassing instead of denial**



**Civics & Basic Concepts**



TODAY +★



**Communication & Social  
Media**



**Action & Mobilisation**



☆☆☆ are the slots per pillar. Everyone collects their own — My DM shows where you stand.

**1 • Special Topic**

Bypassing — the sprint

30'

**2 • The round**

Discussion & wind-down

**The Learning Loop — Learn it. Keep it. • 3★ per pillar → DM Champion • 6★ → DM Master**

## SPECIAL TOPIC

# Bypassing instead of denial

**How to answer misinformation without just contradicting it**

**Warm-up**

5'

**Video**

5'

**Topic**

7'

**Exercise**

5'

**Take-away**

5'

**Why this topic?** Before every vote, claims circulate that aren't true. A "that's not true" helps less than you'd think. There is a second way — and a clear line where it becomes unfair.

**Sprint**

30m

## 1 — WARM-UP

# Phones out



**Scan the QR, enter a name — three questions, everyone at once.**

**[tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz](https://tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz)**

Join — if the QR code acts up

**Open the beamer view →**

Host: starts the game and shows questions, answers, leaderboard

**After each question: answer + explanation — the app does that.**

Time

**5m**

## 2 — VIDEO



# What is bypassing?

Mini Philosophy explains the technique in 90 seconds — in English, with subtitles.



**Video not playing? Scan the QR or open the link:**

**[facebook.com/reel/1160919765939031](https://facebook.com/reel/1160919765939031)**

**Video: Mini Philosophy, “The Bypassing Technique” (Facebook, 1:29)**

Time  
**5m**

## 2 — VIDEO • THE SHORT VERSION

# Bypassing in four sentences

|             |                                                 |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What</b> | Don't contradict — add something true.          |
| <b>How</b>  | True fact, same object, opposite direction.     |
| <b>When</b> | Short claims, before minds are made up.         |
| <b>Line</b> | True facts only, said openly — no manipulation. |

**The video says “don't fact-check” — the study doesn't: a detailed fact-check stays strong.**

## 2 — TOPIC • LIVE EXPERIMENT

# An experiment with you

HEADLINE

**“Tap water is unhealthy.”**

1. The moderator hands out slips: **left** side of the room gets slip **A**, **right** side slip **B**.
2. Read your slip silently. **Don't show it.**
3. Show with **1–5 fingers**: how happy would you be to drink tap water instead of bottled water?

→ **Next slide: we compare the two sides.**

The paper tested with a made-up product. The tap-water example is ours.

Time  
**7m**

## 2 — TOPIC • THE CHECK

# What was on the slips?

### HEADLINE

"Tap water is unhealthy."

**Bypassing** leaves the false claim standing and puts something **true** on the other side of the scale: same object, opposite direction.

### A • DENIAL

"Tap water is **not** unhealthy."

In experiments, after short headlines, it worked **slightly** better than a short denial. A small edge, found repeatedly.

### B • BYPASSING

"Tap water costs a fraction of bottled water and needs no plastic bottle."

**No** edge if people already made up their minds while reading. A detailed fact-check stays strong.

## 2 — TOPIC • WHERE THE LINE IS

# Fair or dodging?

### EXAMPLE • A REAL CONCERN

**“The wolf kills our sheep.”**

That is no rumour. Answering with some other upside would be dodging. Acknowledge first, then talk.

### EXAMPLE • A TRUE CORE

**“Initiatives only make it with forged signatures.”**

If there are individual real cases, acknowledge them first. Then correct the generalisation. Pure bypassing looks like whitewashing.

Bypassing adds a **true** claim to a **false** one. Spin makes a legitimate concern disappear.

### 3 — EXERCISE

# Does bypassing fit here?

#### EXAMPLE

**“The vote result was rigged.”**

1. Form groups of two or three.
2. **2 minutes:** is there something true that speaks against it — or does it need a denial?
3. **One sentence** per group to the round.

**2:00**

► Start timer

Time

**5m**

## 4 — TAKE-AWAY · BOTTOM LINE ★

# “Contradicting misinformation? It’s pointless anyway.”



★ Claim your star now

Your kit for exactly that conversation:



### Check first

Is it really false? If it has a true core, acknowledge that first.



### A true counterweight

Same object, opposite direction, at least as strong — and it has to be true.



### Say it openly

“Do you know this side too?” If that would embarrass you, it’s manipulation.



### Otherwise correct

If nothing true speaks against it: explain in detail, not just “not true”.

Bottom line → Master Checklist · Communication star ★ earned

Time  
5m

**The round**

DEMOCRACY MATTERS

# Merci!

The Learning Loop — design & concept of the gamified workshop  
format



**Slides, quiz & star — everything to revisit**

[tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz/content/bypassing.html](https://tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz/content/bypassing.html)

## FOR THE MODERATOR

# Run sheet



Run sheet on  
your phone

**before** **Print** and cut the slips (A left, B right). No slips: read A to the left half while the right half closes their eyes — then the reverse with B.

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**15:00 (5')** **Warm-up** — QR slide, **open the beamer view**, play the 3 questions. The app shows the explanations.

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**15:05 (5')** **Video** — reel from the slide (1:29, English). Blocked? QR or link. Then the four-sentence short version.

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**15:10 (7')** **Topic** — live experiment (slips, read silently, 1–5 fingers), check slide, then “where the line is” as information.

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**15:17 (5')** **Exercise** — “vote result rigged”: 2’ group, 3’ round, **one** sentence per group. Debrief out loud: nothing true speaks against it — correct it and explain (who counts, who checks, complaints).

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**15:22 (5')** **Take-away** — kit, bottom line onto the Master Checklist, Communication star ★. Never cut. Then buffer, the round.

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**Details:** [docs/runbook-bypassing.md](#) • **To revisit:** [.../content/bypassing.html](#)